

STUDIES
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A NUBIAN PRINCE IN AN EGYPTIAN MONASTERY

By W. E. CRUM

SINCE Professor Griffith thought the legends here to be treated of worth mentioning at the end of his *Christian Documents from Nubia*,¹ a less condensed account of them may be of interest. Something must first be said of the work wherein they lie embedded, a work hitherto unnoticed, I believe, either by Arabists or folk-lorists. Four manuscripts were used:

Arabic:

- A. Paris, *fonds arabe*, No. 278, A.D. 1294 (so De Slane).
- B. „ „ „ No. 279, 14th cent. (so De Slane).
- C. British Museum, Or. 8737, A.D. 1731.

Ethiopic:

- D. „ „ „ Or. 768 (Wright, No. CCLXV), early 18th cent.

I have not seen Paris *arabe* 280 (A.D. 1605), nor the excerpts in *ib.* 283 (13th cent.) and, for the particular stories here in question, have but rarely consulted C, though for the remainder of the book I have been entirely dependent upon it and D. Text and translations are from A (foll. 117 b–130 a), with occasional variants from B (foll. 308 b–341 b) D (foll. 84 a–92 b).² A is finely written, and in pointing and grammar is somewhat more classical than B, whose script inclines to ligatures and whose pointing is more arbitrary.³ BCD seemed to me not seldom to agree, as against A; but of this I cannot be sure. D is a servile version, even translating proper names now and then. What I here offer is a combination of abstract and translation (the latter in inverted commas), with the Arabic text of some interesting passages.

‘The Paradise of Delight’, ‘The Garden of Monks’,⁴ or ‘The Forty Stories of the Monks of the Wâdi Hubaib and others’,⁵ are alternative titles of a collection of tales of varying character and length, almost all relating to Egypt and presumably composed there, even when the scene is laid beyond its borders. I do not pretend to have read the work through and cannot say what further historical and topographical detail might be collected from a complete perusal. My super-

¹ In *Proceedings of the British Academy*, XIV (1928). I had also given a note on the subject in Winlock-Crum-E. White, *Mon. of Epiphanius*, I 142.

² When from C, they are so marked.

³ A generally writes ذ ث, B regularly ط for ط. My copy aims at reproducing the features of A, including the often senseless stop, not used

in B

⁴ Lit. ‘The Gardens of the Monastic Fathers’.

⁵ بساتين الابرار الرهبان, or فردوس النعيم الاربعين خير التي للابرار الرهبان بوادي هبيب وغيره. On works similarly entitled v. my *Ostraca*, No. 250 n., *Mon. of Epiphanius*, I 199 n., adding one attributed to Evagrius اوغرايد (Uri II 467 b).

ficial reading has shown a series of tales, wherein fact—or what is intended to represent it—and fantastic imagination both play their parts. Many questions are suggested by a work of this sort: sources¹ and date, relations with other such collections, non-Christian, perhaps, and non-Egyptian among them.² I will not attempt to discuss these; I can but offer a few notes upon the stories other than the three to be more particularly dealt with below.

In many cases the narrators are named; in only two, so far as I have noticed, are they otherwise known to history: the patriarch Benjamin (*ob. ca.* 662³) relates No. 9 and is mentioned as reigning in Nos. 1 and 2, while John, the next but one after him (*ob.* 689), is named in No. 13. But among the other narrators Isaac, abbot of Dair al-Kalamûn,⁴ 'which is the monastery of Abba Samuel', begins his series with a precisely dated story, No. 24, telling of a barbarian attack on the monastery in A.M. 388 = A.D. 672; while another of his tales, No. 29, names a date two years later.⁵ Both Isaac and another narrator, Victor, head of the celebrated monastery at the Henaton, 'named also the Monastery of Glass',⁶ reappear in the Theban *Synaxarium*, which has taken over at least one piece by each of them,⁷ besides one of those treated of below by Anastasius.⁸ Indeed, the relation of that interesting recension to our collection is one of the problems which would be worth investigation.⁹

The remaining narrators are Macarius 'the bishop', or 'bishop and scribe' (Nos. 17–23),¹⁰ Anastasius abbot of St. Pachôm's monastery¹¹ (Nos. 32, 33, 34, *v.* below), Jacob bishop of Ausîm (Nos. 35, 36),¹² Theodore bishop of Danaṭû (No. 37),¹³ and Isaac bishop of Niniveh, the seventh-century Syrian homelist, whose contribution (No. 38) is a discourse compiled from his writings.¹⁴

Topographical information may be had from most of the stories. No. 1 tells of an ascete from the village (ضبعة) of Ramsîs, in the district of Alexandria,¹⁵ inveigled into various adventures by the demon, disguised as an aged monk. No. 2

¹ Two pieces at least have Coptic stories immediately behind them: Nos. 9 and 39.

² The Syrian month-names in Nos. 32, 33 (*v.* below) need explanation. The only parallel I can recall is Br. Mus. Or. 2328, a modern copy of the Egyptian (Coptic) *Synaxarium*, arranged according to the Syrian months.

³ Chaîne, *Chronologie*, 252.

⁴ In SW. of the Fayyûm (Amélineau, *Géogr.* 388).

⁵ Date of the consecration of a church.

⁶ *P.S.B.A.* XXIX 301; Amélineau, *l.c.* 531.

⁷ Of the former on 13th Kîhak, of the latter on 30th Hatûr. Another by Victor (on 7th Tûbah) is not in our collection. The stories by Victor of the Henaton in *Paris arabe* No. 305 may be by this author.

⁸ No. 34, on 23rd Kîhak, *v.* below, p. 148.

⁹ On this *Synaxarium*, which contained so much that the current, probably Nitrian, recension ignores, *v. Mon. of Epiphanius*, I 215 and *passim*.

¹⁰ Not identified. Cf. M. the bishop in some diptychs, as *BIF.* v 97.

¹¹ Doubtless that at Pbow (Fâu).

¹² Wâsim in *D.* *v. MIF.* XXXVI 231.

¹³ In W. Delta, *v. Amélineau*, 385.

¹⁴ *D.*: 'A compilation by one of the saints, from the words of the holy Isaac the Syrian, when the brethren begged of him a word of comfort,' beginning with the discourse on the 4 causes of sin (cf. *Paris ar.* 260, 4). His date is apparently disputed, as well as his precise creed. In Egypt, at any rate, the Jacobites claimed him (*v. Baumstark, Gesch.* 224).

¹⁵ SE. of Damanhûr, Merkaz of Tah al-Barûd.

is the story of a monk from ẖariat al-Malik, a village named later 'in the speech of the people of that land' Tîdah.¹ In No. 3 the narrator is an ascete who goes to the Salt Desert—probably that of Nitria²—and tells of another hermit in the desert of Aklîmâtâs, 'now that of the Fayyûm'.³ No. 4 relates to a holy man in the city of Afrikîyah, No. 5 to one at Aghribû-Agrapiû, in an Indian isle.⁴ No. 7 is by Joseph from the town of Şân (Tanis). In No. 9 the patriarch Benjamin tells of his flight before Heraclius to Ashmûnain and of the sinful priest miraculously punished.⁵ No. 12 relates to a saint at Rashîd (Rosetta), No. 13 to a man of Afragûn,⁶ who is sent to Samanûd, 'the city of our fathers the patriarchs'.⁷ No. 16 is about a blacksmith from Barḡah. In Nos. 19 and 20 the town of Nikiûs is mentioned, in No. 21 we read of the river of Birmâ.⁸ No. 25 tells the story of a priest of Darûṭ,⁹ and in Nos. 28 and 33 we hear of the village of Şaghîrah in the Şa'îd.¹⁰ In No. 36 the bishop of Ausîm, journeying westward to Mariûṭ, falls in with barbarians and saves the life of their victim; while the bishop of Danaṭû in No. 37 meets a man, at Dair Abi Abshâi, bringing pomegranate-seeds from one of the gardens of Paradise.¹¹ In No. 39 the pious son of the governor of the City of Treasure is none other than the bloodless martyr Dorotheus (here nameless), whose father ruled in Isauria.¹² The last story is concerned with Silas, a cave-dwelling anchorite at ẖârah near Jerusalem, and his friend at ẖalamûn.¹³ So much can be gleaned in merely turning the pages of the manuscripts; much more has, of course, escaped my notice.

Let us turn now to the three stories with which we are more immediately concerned. There is no internal evidence as to the period to which these pieces relate, but since the seventh century is indicated for others, we may suppose that these, too, are intended to depict the conditions of that age. It seems unlikely that the incidents narrated should be wholly imaginary; they may well record a tradition surviving in the monastery, which must at all times have been liable to visits from 'barbarian' tribes, coming down the river from beyond the

¹ The old name is translated in *D* 572: 5077707; (cf. ?? بولسبور Amélineau, 366), the later 722; confirming *B*, while *C* has Tandah; v. Amélineau, 504.

² بركة مليحة. Cf. No. 32 below and my *Ostraca* l.c.

³ Cf. ? Κλίμαξ, beyond Scete (*Hist. Laus.*, § 27).

⁴ Both 'isle' and 'India' are terms too vague to allow of easy identification.

⁵ Coptic of this: DeVVis *Homélie*s, 176 *B*, Paris 129¹⁴ 122 *S*.

⁶ *V. Mém. Inst. Franç.* xxxvi 22 for various spellings. *D* has 556677.

⁷ Doubtless in reference to John of Samanûd, the reigning patriarch, named in this story.

⁸ نهر برما, *D* 617: 50657; Birmâ E. of Kafr az-Zayât.

⁹ دروط, *D* 6670: (from the form دروط), 'one of the towns of El-Asmônên'.

¹⁰ S. of Esne, near Namassa (Boinet). Not in Ibn Duḡmâḡ. In *D* 8666: as if صغيرة.

¹¹ روضة من رياض الجنة (Mr. Guest gave me the translation).

¹² The Coptic original (no Greek has been found) in Cod. Vat. LVIII 65-78 (cf. Zoega, 133), whence Isauria, with the article 72727272, has been converted into *Θησαυρία, or مدينة الكنز, which last reappears in the glossary Paris 43, 79b.

¹³ Presumably the monastery near Jordan.

ولكن كون على حذر من قوم من بني حام • ياتوك عراء الاجساد في اوساطهم جلود المعزي • وسلاحهم من جريد النخل • وطعامهم من دبيب الارض • ياكلون الفار والتعبان • والفرس² • والورن³ • والسحلفه⁴ • والذيب⁵ (121 b) والنمر والكلب والقط⁶ • ولا ينجسون شيئاً من اللحوم للحيثه النجسه • وهم اقويا شجعان • لا يطيق بهم احدا من سكان هذه الارض⁷ • فيملكون⁸ اكثرها ويسبون اهلها • ويقتلون ابطالها • ويرعون بافواهم كرومها وبساتينها • ويكون على هذه الاعمال منهم وبالا عظيماً⁹ • ويأتون اليك يا ابي انسطاسيوس وقد طعنت في السن • ولا قدرة لك على القيام مستوياً • وتنظرهم بعينك وبعد ذلك تموت قبل مخاطبتهم • ويمدون ايضاً ايديهم في هذا الدير • ويريدون فساداً ومن فيه من الرهبان فلا يقدرّون • فاندر الرئيس الذي بعدك ان يعد لهم طعاماً وشراباً من جميع الاطعمه لللال والحرام • فاذا هم اكلوا من الطعام وشربوا من الشراب • فانهم يعطوك¹⁰ اماناً لهذا الدير • ولا يفسدون احداً فيه • لان الذي ياتي اليه ابن اخوا المقدم¹¹ فيهم • واصحابه¹² • وفيه رحمه • واعرف واوصى ولدك الذي له الرئاسة بعدك • يميز وجهه ويعرفه بشخصه • فهو ياتيه ليلاً ويدخل الى هذا الدير ويصير فيه راهباً • ويكون قديساً • ويكون لهذا الدير رحمه من الله عظيمه الذي ارسله اليه • لان هؤلاء الجند¹³ يقيموا في هذه الارض ثلثه سنين (122) ويجعلوها مثل القفار • ولا يتركوا فيها اثمار ولا اشجار • لانهم خلق كثير لا يحصى عددهم •

¹ BC العرس, H07-7: (or this ? = next word). ² الوزغ. ³ 7-04: (7-06 tortoise).
⁴ ضب, C ظبيغ (ضبع), H00 (X-0-0):. ⁵ D om. ⁶ الديار, 00487 (00287):.
⁷ فيملكون, 0m6-0:.. ⁸ وبأ عظيماً, 00780:000:.. ⁹ يعطوه. ¹⁰ 04-7:..
¹¹ 000-0:.. ¹² 000:..

‘And beware of the people of the children of Hām. They shall come unto thee naked of body, about their middles goatskins, and their weapons palm-branches and their food creeping things. They shall eat the mouse and the snake and the weasel¹ and the lizard and the tortoise and the wolf² and (121 b) the leopard and the dog and the cat and shall deem naught unclean of vile meats and fowl. And they are strong and brave and none among the dwellers in this land may prevail against them. And they shall possess³ the most of it and shall take its people captive and slay its mighty ones and with their mouths they shall devour its vineyards and its orchards and by reason of them there shall be upon these provinces sore affliction. And they shall come unto thee, O my father Anastasius, when thou art far gone in years and not able to stand firmly. And with thine eyes thou shalt behold them and after that shalt die, ere ever thou hast talked with them. And moreover they shall stretch forth their hands in this monastery, with intent to destroy it and the monks within it; yet shall they not be able. But do thou admonish the abbot that (shall be) after thee, that he make ready for them meat and drink, of all meats permitted and forbidden. And when they shall have eaten of the meat

¹ A ‘horse’ (prob. error), D a word I cannot identify.

² B another sort of lizard, CD ‘hyena’.

³ BD ‘destroy’.

and drunk of the drink, they shall give thee¹ a deed of protection for this monastery and shall do no hurt to any one therein. For he that cometh hither is brother's son to the chief among them and their fellows and he is merciful.² And tell and admonish thy son, that shall have the headship after thee, that he discern his face and know his appearance. By night shall he come and shall enter into this monastery and become a monk here and a saint; and there shall be unto this monastery great mercy from God that sent him hither. Now these soldiers shall abide in this land three years (122 a) and shall make it as the desert and shall leave therein neither fruit nor tree; for they are a mighty multitude, that cannot be numbered.'

He (*i.e.* the leader of the horde) will come like a thief and hireling (citing John x 10), but the monastery shall go unscathed.

فاذا كان في اليوم الرابع عشر من اب^١. تاتي الى فتجدني في عنجق^٢. وهذا مكان في صدر (122 b) البرية. يسكن فيه طير السما وياوي اليه وحش البرية. وما فيها من السباع الوحشة. وذلك لاجل ما فيها من اما المجتمع من الامطار والسيول.

^٢ ⲁⲛⲓⲕⲁⲓ.

^١ ابيب, ⲁⲃⲓⲃ.

'And', Mercurius proceeds, 'when the 14th day of Âb³ is come thou shalt come unto me and shalt find me at 'Anjak⁴, which is a place in the midst (122 b) of the desert, where dwell the birds of heaven and whither the beasts of the desert resort and wherein are all manner of ravening wild creatures and that by reason of the water gathered there from rains and torrents.' Anastasius is to remain by him three days, at the end of which Mercurius will die and the abbot is charged to carry his body back to the monastery for burial. Eventually the corpse is borne thither by three of the wild animals that had gathered to mourn the hermit's death. Mercurius dead, the story continues:

واذا قوماً قد وصلوا من ارض النوبة فملكوا ارض النخل والسدر والسنط^٢. وهي^١ اسوان واسنا وارمنت وابيود^٣. وجميع تلك الاعمال. (123 b) وكان كما قال هذا الراهب وما صار اليه.

^٣ ⲁⲃⲓⲃ, ابنود.

^٢ ارض.

^١ ⲁⲛⲓⲕⲁⲓ: ⲁⲃⲓⲃ: ⲁⲃⲓⲃ.

'And lo, there arrived folk from the land of the Nubians, and they possessed the land of the date-palm and the lotus-tree and the acacia,⁵ which is Aswân and Asnâ and Armant and Abnûd⁶ and all those provinces (123 b). And it befell even as that monk had said.' Thus, after a few pious reflexions, the story ends.

¹ BD 'him'.

² Probably as D 'and among their fellows is mercy'.

³ B by error Abîb. Corresponds to Coptic 21st Misrah, D Nahasê.

⁴ D 'Anzak. An imaginary oasis?

⁵ D merely 'the date-palm and other trees'.

⁶ So BD, A 'Abyûd'. Abnûd, a village below Kift, presumably of more importance formerly. May here indicate the northern limit of the district named. Cf. its use in next story.

في ارضنا • وقال ان روحي صارت (125) الى السموات ورايت اهل العذاب وما هم فيه • ورايت اهل النعيم وما هم فيه • واظهر عجائب كثيرة • كان يقول ان روحي بعد قبصها عادت الى جسدي واندردنا انا فاني الى هذه الارض ونملكها ثلثة سنين ونعود الى ارضنا • وكنت اذا قد القيت نفسي¹ اليه ورغبت الى قدسه وبشرني اني اصير راهبا واسكن في دير انبا بخوم • المكان الذي كان² فيه راهبا • واسكن منزله³ • واصلى على قبره • واوراني كيف صور⁴ القديس للجليل انبا بخوم • وصنعها لي في لوحا من الخشب • وانا عملتها في⁵ هذا اللوح الذهب • وان ذلك الراهب مضى الى جبل عنجق⁶ من⁷ ارضنا • وهوذا قد تم ما قاله • ولم يخل منه شيئا⁸ • فعلمت انا نسطاسيوس انه ولدي القديس مرقوريوس⁹ الراهب • فتعجبت واطرقت بوجهي الى الارض • وكنت ساهيا¹⁰ زمانا طويلا • فلما رفعت راسي • قال لي الترجمان يا ابي الراهب ما هوذا انت فيه مفكرا فقلت¹¹ سبحان الله الذي اعطى قديسيه ومختاربه واصفياء • الراغبين اليه هذه العطية واجلهم بها • يا ولدي هذا الراهب الذي ذكرت وصوله الى ارضكم هو في هذا الدير كان راهبا • (125 b) وارضا الله باعماله • وهوذا ما كان من حاله • فسبح ذلك الرجل الله كثيرا • وقال ان هذا هو العجب • انه انباني بما كان كذلك هذا الاب • ثم التفت اليّ وقال لي اني اتيت لالبس الثوب¹² والاسكيم • واكون من اولاد القديس انبا بخوم • الى حين انقضى مدتي¹³ • فبادر يا ابي الراهب والبسي الثياب •¹⁴ فقلت انك راهبا من قبل اليوم • لان مرقوريوس اندرك بذلك • واندردني واني لا اشك انك¹⁵ ابن اخي الملك قال نعم • وانا اعطيتك امانا في هذا الدير • وفي هذا اليوم وهو السابع والعشرين من ايلول¹⁶ عادوا بني حام الى ارضهم • وانا بعد ذلك في اليوم الثالث عشر من كانون الاول¹⁷ البسته الثياب¹⁸ والاسكيم • واسكنته بيت ذلك الراهب مرقوريوس • واوريته قبره • وكان فيه يصلى ويدكر قدس مرقوريوس¹⁹ وقوله • انه لم يكذب في لفظه واحدة • انظروا الى قدس هذا الراهب وفصايه • وهذا ما كان من امر بني حام • انهم ما يبقى احد منهم في هذه الارض الا هذا الراهب • وكان قديسا كثير الصوم والصلاه • وهذا ما كان من امر هذا الراهب • وكنت (126) وقت لباسه الثياب اسميته قفري •²⁰ كما كان في اللوح مكتوب • الذي اعطاني اياه امانا على هذا الدير • اسمعوا يا اخوتي واحباي انا نسطاسيوس المسكين • بينما انا جالس في دبري واذا سيارة قد اتت يطلبوني طلبا عنيفا²¹ فخرجت اليهم وقلت ماذا تريدوا • فقالوا نريد نسطاسيوس اب هذا الدير • فقلت انا هو • فقالوا ان عندك رجل من اولاد حام وهو ابن اخو ممروا²² ابن صلبان الملك الذي افسد هذه الارض • وقد جعلته راهبا وهو يكاتب عمه باخبار هذه الارض • وانا نريده • والا نحن نقتل جميع من في هذا الدير ونطلق فيه النار • ولا نترك فيه شيئا من العماره •²³ وكان جميع ذلك من الشيطان عدوا للخير • فقلت هوذا الدير امامكم وجميع من فيه • وهوذا انا قايما في وسطكم²⁴ • فادخلوا واكشفوا وفتشوا جيدا • فادا ما قدرتم عليه²⁵ فخذوه ولا تخافوا احدا • فاني ما اعرف من هذا الانسان الذي انتم تذكروه • وانهم دخلوا وفتشوا الدير ولم يتركوا فيه

¹ 89 b 7. 2. 3. 4. 5. 6. 7. 8. 9. 10. 11. 12. 13. 14. 15. 16. 17. 18. 19. 20. 21. 22. 23. 24.

هو.

مسكنه.

4. 5. 6. 7. 8. 9. 10. 11. 12. 13. 14. 15. 16. 17. 18. 19. 20. 21. 22. 23. 24.

على.

6. 7. 8. 9. 10. 11. 12. 13. 14. 15. 16. 17. 18. 19. 20. 21. 22. 23. 24.

في.

وعلمنا صحته +

and so always. مرقوريوس

10. 11. 12. 13. 14. 15. 16. 17. 18. 19. 20. 21. 22. 23. 24.

11. +

12. D. om. الصوف

13. مدته حياتي

14. 15. 16. 17. 18. 19. 20. 21. 22. 23. 24.

15. الا انك

16. 17. 18. 19. 20. 21. 22. 23. 24.

17. 18. 19. 20. 21. 22. 23. 24.

18. 19. 20. 21. 22. 23. 24.

19. As before.

20. 21. 22. 23. 24.

21. 22. 23. 24.

22. مروان, D. om. the names. +

23. والبنا +

24. بينكم.

25. 26. 27. 28. 29. 30. 31. 32. 33. 34.

مكائنا. ¹ ولم يدخلوا الى منزل هذا الراهب قفري. ولا علموا به ولا المنزل الذي كان فيه. فخرجوا وقالوا ان هذا امر اعظيما. وان (126 b) الساعى اليها قد كذب ² ولم يرشدنا. والتفتوا الى رجل كان معهم. من ناحية تسمى صغيرة ³ كما اسمها. وكان ساعيا. ⁴ لانه كان شريرا كذابا. قتالا. ⁵ سفيها. ناما مقاطعا. لا يخاف الله. ولا يعرف الاله. ⁶ وكان لاهيا بالزنا وشرب الخمر. واكتساب المال من غير حل. فسلط الله عليه هولا القوم عند وصولهم. فاخذوا جميع ما يملك. وسبوا له ثلثه بنات. ⁷ وقتلوا له ثلثه ⁸ اولاد من الرجال الاشد الاقويا. ولم يرجع عن طغيانه ولا اعتبر بما ناله. ⁹ وكان يقول انه ياخذ قفري الراهب ابن اخي الملك. فيقتله عوضا عن بنيه وبناته. ولم يدري انه ¹⁰ بغض الانتقام. وفي اخره جهنم. ¹¹ فاخذوه وربطوا في عنقه حبل من شعر المعزا. وعلقوه على حائط الدبر فمات لوقته.

قاتولا. ⁵ $\sigma\sigma\eta\tau\phi.\epsilon.\epsilon.$ ⁴ $\gamma\lambda\eta\tau.$ ³ كذبنا. ² ولم يدخلوا اليه + ¹.
من الرزايا + ⁹ Om., D = A. ⁸ ابكار + ⁷. يعرف له اله. ⁶
D. = اخلا واسا امام الله وانه انتقم منه في ديناه + ¹⁰ نار جهنم. ¹¹

The Thirty-Third Story

Relates how, after the arrival of the children of Hâm in the land of Abnûd¹ and Aswân, as 'the saintly youth' (Mercurius) had foretold, Anastasius began to observe their behaviour, 'how that they did eat what is forbidden rather than what is permitted and forbade naught among diversities of meats and how they hunted the beasts of the river² also and ate thereof and how that they ate of fish that no man eateth, nor took hurt thereby'. The barbarians carried fire and sword through the land and on (124 a) a certain night 'lo, there came to us a great horde of this Abyssinian³ folk, the children of Hâm, naked of body and about their middles goatskins, wherewith to cover their nakedness, and in their hands weapons of palm-branches. And they encamped without the monastery and we suffered no hurt from them. And we brought forth meat unto them and they did eat and drink and they drank. And when they were minded to move on, the chief among them gave unto this monastery an undertaking and it was a tablet of yellow brass,⁴ whereon were written three lines in the Greek character and therein it was thus: "I, Ḳafrîr,⁵ son of the brother of Ghâyân, son of Marwâ, son of Şalbân,⁶ have written this tablet for this monastery. I warn whoso shall do it harm or lay hands on its possessions or its victuals or aught else, that he

¹ As in last note.

² D 'of the desert'.

³ B 'Nubian', D 'Ethiopian'.

⁴ D 'gold-coloured copper'.

⁵ B 'Ḳafrîl', D 'Ḳefreyâ.' Miswritten for Ḳafrî (v. below). The spelling would be against identifying this with كرى, a later king cited by Roeder, l.c. 369. Were the name and its bearer

imaginary, one might recall قفري 'anchorite' (Dozy, II 383). Ḳafrî is again the name of a camel-herd in the 13th story—at least according to the *Synax.*, 30th Hatûr. But C has قوريل and D $\phi\epsilon\delta\alpha$, recalling the reading of B here. Nothing connects him with Nubia.

⁶ B 'Ghâbât, s. of Marwân, s. of Ş.' D 'Abôt, s. Marwân, s. Ş.'

shall go unto perdition.”¹ And he departed and those with him, but the tablet stayed in this monastery. And the sojourn of that folk was three years and it was so that when in that space there came unto us people bent upon destruction, we brought forth to them that tablet and they did obeisance unto it and turned about and departed.

‘And at the end of the three years of this folk’s holding sway, there came unto us a man and with him three servants attending upon him and bearing up his raiment, lest it should fall to the ground. And in his hand was a staff of palm-branch, whereon he leaned, and in the other hand he bare a sword; and upon his head as it were an ell of (124 *b*) silken strip, bound about it, as women use. And when we beheld him we marvelled at him and said: “What manner of devil is this, that is come unto this monastery, and what would he?” But as for me, I knew from my son, the saintly monk, how that the time was fulfilled and that power no longer remained unto them. For this man was of the children of Hâm and was seeking to enter the monastery. And they² opened unto him the gate and he came in and sought the church and we led him thither. And I, Anastasius, went before him, for I remembered³ from my son the monk what had been foretold me. And having entered the church he stood before the sanctuary and prayed. And when he had made an end of praying, he turned him about and said unto me: “I would that thou show me the chief man of this monastery.” Now he was a barbarian and one of his servants interpreted for him. And I said unto him: “And what wouldest thou of him?” And he said: “When I see him, then will I tell him what I would have of him.” And I said unto him: “I am he.” And he sat down and caused me to sit and he brought forth from amid his garments that which hung about his neck upon his breast, a picture upon red gold, graven with an iron pen,⁴ and it was a picture of our saintly father, Abba Pachôm. And I marvelled and said: “O master, know ye then in your land the saintly Abba Pachôm?” And he⁵ said: “Yea, for there journeyed through our land a young monk, clothed in woollen raiment,⁶ in whom we beheld much sanctity. And he preached⁷ in our land, and said, ‘My spirit went (125 *a*) to heaven and I saw the people of punishment, such as were there, and I saw the people of grace, such as were there; and many a marvel was revealed’. And he said (further), ‘My spirit, after that it had been rapt away, returned unto my body’. And we were bidden come unto this land and possess it three years and (thereafter) return unto our own land. But I had set my heart upon it (*sc.*? this monastery) and longed for its holiness. And it had been foretold

¹ Lit. ‘be with the damned’.

² *BD* ‘the gate-keeper.’

³ Lit. ‘knew.’

⁴ *D* ‘iron reed’, *AB* ‘reed (pen)’.

⁵ So *D*, *AB* ‘they’.

⁶ On monastic garments of wool *v. Mon. of*

Epiphanius, I 157. There is not much evidence for their use in Egypt. The woollen cloak or blanket in my *Theol. Texts* 158 is of hair in the Boh. and Greek parallels.

⁷ *D* ‘held service, said mass.’

me how that I should become a monk and should dwell in the monastery of Abba Pachôm, even where he had been a monk, and that I should dwell in his abode and pray upon his tomb. And it was revealed unto me of what aspect was the likeness of the saintly and revered Abba Pachôm and the same was made for me upon a wooden tablet; but I made it¹ upon a tablet of gold. And that monk journeyed to mount 'Anjak in our country² and, lo, what he said hath been brought to pass, neither hath aught thereof been diminished".'

Anastasius, recognizing in the monk thus referred to his spiritual son Mercurius, falls to meditating upon God's marvels. (125 *b*) He is interrupted by his visitor, who turns to him with the words: "I am come to don the robe³ and the habit (σχιμα) and to become of the children of the saintly Abba Pachôm, until such time as I finish my span.⁴ And do thou make speed, O father monk, to clothe me in the robe." But I said: "Thou wast a monk ere this day. For Mercurius forewarned thee of this and forewarned me and I doubt not but thou art the king's brother's son." He said: "Yea. And I it was gave thee an undertaking in this same monastery". And upon that day, which was the 27th day of Ailûl,⁵ the children of Hâm turned again to their own land. And thereafter, on the 13th day of Kânûn the First,⁶ I clothed him with the robe⁷ and the habit and set him to dwell in the chamber⁸ of that monk Mercurius and I showed him his tomb. And there he was used to pray and to meditate upon the saintly Mercurius and his words, how that he had not been false in one of them".⁹ (126 *a*) On the occasion of his taking the habit Anastasius gives the novice the name of Kafirî, that whereby he was called upon the tablet given to the monastery.

But the inhabitants of the surrounding district, which had suffered so much at the hands of the Nubian raiders, were bent upon revenge. A band of them arrived at the monastery and demanded of the abbot 'the son of the brother of Mamrû,¹⁰ son of Şalbân the king,' who had become a monk, but who had sent back accounts of this land to his uncle. Anastasius, however, succeeded in concealing Kafirî's whereabouts, whereupon the barbarians turned upon their informer, a man of ill repute from the village of Şaghîrah,¹¹ and, convinced that he had misled them, they bound a cord of goat's hair about his neck and hanged him outside the monastery wall;¹² after which they took themselves off, leaving the monks unharmed. The story ends with an account of Kafirî's saintliness and prowess; for he cowed and then slew single-handed a terrific lion (127 *b*), a deed whereby his reputation among the brethren was greatly increased.

¹ *i.e.* 'I had it copied'.

² See p. 142. The phrase again recalls the Theban *Synaxarium*, where ٤٤٤ is similarly used of the district to which a group of the stories in it relate.

³ *B* 'woollen (robe)'.

⁴ *B* + 'of life'.

⁵ Corresponds to Coptic 30th Tût, *D* Mas-karam.

⁶ Corresponds to Coptic 13th Kîhak, *D* Taḥšâš.

⁷ *B* 'woollen robe'.

⁸ Lit. 'house'.

⁹ The Arabic is printed beyond this, to the point indicated below.

¹⁰ *B* 'Marwân'.

¹¹ *v.* above, p. 139.

¹² Printed Arabic text ends here.

The Thirty-fourth Story

Of this little need be said, since it is to be read, in a slightly abbreviated form, in the *Synaxarium*.¹ It tells how Kāfrî, after three years in the Pachomian community, obtains leave to visit a friend in Shenoute's monastery and with him is miraculously transported in a single night to Jerusalem, whence, after visiting the holy places, they are as marvellously brought again to Upper Egypt.

¹ 23rd Kihak.